Fifth Sunday of Easter (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 3rd May 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Tuesday, Thursday and Friday at 10am.
St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Month's Mind Mass: For Tony Deighan on Saturday 2nd May at 6pm.
Anniversary Mass: For Hugh Henry (Jun) on Saturday 9th May at 6pm.
Anniversary Mass: For Philip Mullan on Sunday 3rd May at 10am.
St. Joseph's Church (Vigil) - Anniversary Mass:
Anniversary Mass: For Patsy Marti on Sunday 3rd May at 11.30am.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Mary's Church in May.
Eucharistic Adoration: - No Adoration on Bank Holiday Monday.
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Errigal Youth Group - "Mary and Me" Our next youth group gathering will take place on Sunday 10th May, and this month we will be reflecting on Mary, honouring her during the month traditionally dedicated to her. Together we will explore who Mary is, her role in our faith, and what her example means for our lives today. Details: Date: Sunday 10th May Time: 7:00pm - 8:30pm. Venue: Minor Hall, Glenullin GAC, Curraghmore Road. For: Young people aged 11–14. All young people are very welcome — whether they attend regularly or are joining us for the first time. We look forward to an evening of faith, friendship, and fun. "Do whatever He tells you." - John 2:5

Errigal Parish Pastoral Survey - Summary of Findings: Thank you to all who participated in our recent "Future of Parish Life" survey. We were greatly encouraged by the strong response, and your feedback has provided valuable guidance for the Errigal Pastoral Group as we plan for the months ahead. A summary page with the full breakdown of results is available for parishioners to view. From the survey, there was particular support for the development of: A. Bereavement Ministry, and B. Parish Pilgrimage Group (including interest in Lough Derg).
In light of this, the Pastoral Group will now begin working on these two priority areas. Further details will be shared as plans progress.

While the group can only take forward a limited number of initiatives at one time, we were heartened to see strong interest in several other suggested groups. If any parishioners feel called to help establish or lead one of these additional groups, you are warmly invited to contact Fr Crowley or any member of the Pastoral Group.
Thank you once again for your thoughtful contributions and for your continued support of parish life in Errigal.

Parish Youth Ministry Evening: Derry Diocesan Youth will host an evening for Parish Youth Ministry leaders and volunteers on Wednesday 20th May in Claudy Parish Centre at 7.00pm. The evening will provide an opportunity for parishes to reflect on their current ministries for young people and share practice. The focus of the evening will be on the GIFT Programme. This is a post-confirmation programme aimed at Year 8 initially and delivered through parish. If you would like more information or would like to attend, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org 02871264087. You are asked, please, to bring this email to the attention of those involved in youth ministry in your parish(es), who are also very welcome to come along.

Prayer for Examinations: Loving God, as I begin this time of exams, I feel some anxiety and frustration. Help me to stay focused. Give me a clear mind, to perform to the best of my ability. Help me to study with dedication and vigour. Grant me silence so that I may process the knowledge I have obtained. Let me sleep peacefully at night, so that I am refreshed and renewed for my upcoming exams. Be with me, gentle God, during these days. Undoubtedly, there will be moments when I want to quit and give up. Please sustain me, Holy One. Guide me during times of trouble. Help me be satisfied with the work I have done but also help me to see areas that I may improve upon academically in the future. Amen.

St. Mary's - May Altar Society: Josephine McKeowm. Philip McKeown, Naula Mullan, and Paul Mullan. **St. Mary's - May Collectors - (Saturday)** Barney O'Kane.
(Sunday) Seamus O'Kane & Charlie O'Kane.
St. Joseph's - May Altar Society: Tracy Mullan, Katherine Ann McGoldrick, and Katherine Anderson.
St. Joseph's - May Counters: Danny & Anne McCloskey, and Grainne McNeill.
St. Joseph's May Collectors: (Sunday) Sean Quinn, John Heaney, and John Padraig O'Kane.

The Little Way Novena in St Eugene's Cathedral - 9th May to 17th May: The theme is ***'My peace consists in remaining little"***. The Novena will begin at the 7.30 pm Mass with the Sacrament of the Sick on Saturday, 9th May. Devotions and talk on Sunday 10th May at 6.00 pm. Monday to Friday (11th to 15th May) Novena Masses at 6.30am and 10.00am each morning and an evening service with a guest speaker at 7.30 pm. Saturday 16th May 10.00am Mass for those who have died. The Novena will close on Sunday with blessing of the roses, 17th May at 3.00 pm. Everyone is welcome to St Eugene's Cathedral for this time of prayer and petition.

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine: Will take place on Saturday 6th June. In conjunction with the All-Ireland Rosary Rally, we will join those gathered to celebrate at our National Eucharistic and Marian Shrine. For those for whom it is convenient, buses will leave St. Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, at 8am: cost £50, which includes dinner in Knock House Hotel following the conclusion of the Mass in the Basilica. For further information,

please contact Karen in the parish office at St Eugene's on 7126 2894 or by email at cathedral@derrydiocese.org. Full schedule to follow.

Lough Derg - Three Day Pilgrimage: Friday 29th May - Saturday 15th August (Season) Adm - €85 Booking advised. Concessions available for students, seniors and groups. Tel (00353) 719861518. info@loughderg.org **One Day Retreat** - A Day of Guided Prayer and Reflection. May - 3rd/4th/ 9th/12th/17th/23rd/25th

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 9th May in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 17th May at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 6th May at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Friday 1st May using the parish email address, this will indicate to the team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 182 boxes of envelopes in circulation.
Returns - (Pink/Yellow - 98 White - 65)
St. Mary's - Parish: £565 Renovation: £255
St. Joseph's - Parish: £365 Renovation: £380
Final Trócaire Collection - £6,461.00 (including)
St. Patrick's & St. Josephs School - £1,725.00
St. Columba's School - £335.00.

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 3, 16, 28, 30. Next week's Jackpot is £4,500. £50 Winner - Niall Mullan.
Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 12, 22, 24, 30. Jackpot £10.000. £25 winners - Pat Mullan, Damian Hasson, Eugene Hasson, and Majella McCloskey.

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers
St. Mary's Church - Church Readers 9th/10th May
Saturday Vigil - Caroline Loughery.
Sunday Morning - Seamus O'Kane.
If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please gave your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.
Eucharistic Ministers - 9th/10th May
Saturday Vigil - Paddy Bradley & Don Robinson.
Sunday Morning - Josephine McKeown & Brian Mullan.
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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers
St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 9th/10th May
Saturday Vigil -
Sunday Morning - Michael Leadon.
If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please gave your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead Mc Nicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.
Eucharistic Ministers - 9th/10th May

Saturday Vigil -
Sunday Morning - Philippa Hasson & Meabh Close.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St Conleth: Is believed to come from the Wicklow area. While living as a hermit he was persuaded by St Brigid to act as a priest for her community in Kildare. He was venerated as a great saint and Cogitosus, in his Life of Brigid calls him bishop and abbot of the monks of Kildare. He was buried beside Brigid in the great church there. **Tuesday - St. Edmund Rice (1762 - 1844):** Came from Callan, Co. Kilkenny. After his young wife's early death. He sold his processions and dedicated his life to the education of the poor. To advance the work, he gathered other like-minded men who took religious vows together to work for the Catholic education of boys. He is a model of patient and cheerful acceptance of the sufferings God sends, a true lay apostle and a deeply committed religious. **Friday - Bl. John Sullivan:** Was born in Eccles Street, Dublin on the 8th May 1861. He was baptised in the tradition of his father - Church of Ireland. At the age of thirty-five he was received into the Catholic Church. He entered the Jesuits in 1900 and was ordained a priest. His reputation for holiness and as a person of prayer spread rapidly and he was always available to the sick, the poor and anyone in need. He died 19th February 1933. His declaration as Blessed on the 13th May 2017 at St. Francis Xavier Church, Gardiner Street, Dublin, was the first ever Beatification celebrated in Ireland.

Diocesan Vocations: Our first reading tells the story of the selection of the first seven deacons. We pray for those recently, or soon to be, ordained to the Diaconate. Here in the Diocese of Derry, we pray God's blessing on Deacon Stephen Baxter who will be ordained to the priesthood on 14th June, that the Lord will bless him in his future ministry.
For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - **'The Word of the Lord'** as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Derry Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima: We are inviting young people aged 16+ to join us on pilgrimage to Fatima for five nights from 3rd to 8th August. This will be a unique experience for young people and an opportunity to engage with their peers from around the world in a faith context. Cost is £820 and there will be a budget plan to help with this. Names

and deposit of £100 are required as soon as possible to secure a place. For more information or to book in please contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org tel - 71264087

Accord Facilitators Needed: Accord is inviting volunteers to train as facilitators for its **Marriage Preparation Programmes**, supporting couples preparing for the Sacrament of Marriage. Facilitators work as part of a small local team and help lead up to four programmes each year. Free professional training is provided. To find out more or apply: Tel: 01 505 3112 Email: marriagepreparation@accord.ie
Closing date for applications: 29th May. Please consider sharing your experience of marriage to support couples preparing for this important sacrament.

Catholic School Leadership Development Opportunities: The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre, working in Partnership with Saint Mary's University, Twickenham, offers a number of avenues for the professional development and spiritual formation of Catholic school leaders. The Full Masters in Catholic School Leadership is a post graduate degree dedicated to the professional development and spiritual formation of Catholic school leaders. A Post Graduate Certificate and Diploma are also offered. These avenues are a great opportunity for those currently in leadership roles and those who aspire to, or have an interest in, leadership roles within the Catholic School system. If you are interested in registering for any of the options in September 2026, attending an online information session on Monday 8th June at 4pm, or require any further information, please contact the Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre on 004428 71264087 or email tferry@derrydiocese.org

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes 2026: Monday 29th June to Friday 3rd July: Due to the great demand for places, we have secured 50 extra seats ex-Dublin direct to Lourdes and return, with complimentary bus to the Airport. The fare is £895 pps full board. If you wish to book please contact the pilgrimage office at 164 Bishop St. Derry, Tel 02871 260293, email: derrypilgrim@outlook.com as soon as possible.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!
Children's Liturgy plans to run again at St. Joseph's Glenullin on the Sunday mornings of Lent. New volunteers are required to assist. This is an excellent opportunity to help our children and young JPII people be more involved! If interested in helping out, during the preparation seasons of Advent and Lent, please contact Clare Mullan 07812993538 so vetting can be processed and a rota organised.

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray.

Fatima Trip - June 2026: Fully escorted group pilgrimage to Fatima, accompanied by Spiritual Director. 26th June - 3rd July 2026. Direct daytime flights, Belfast to Porto. Staying in 4* Hotel. Full board. Services of JWT pilgrimage guide. Daily Mass and Spiritual activities. Cost £895pps. Early booking offer - £100 off if paid in full by 3rd November 2025. Further details, please contact Christina Lagan: 07803192621.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters'* - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titles Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

Foyle Hospice 'Make a will Month': During the month of March local solicitors very kindly agree to waive their usual Will-writing fee in return for a suggested £100 donation to Foyle Hospice. A list of participating solicitors can be found at foylehospice.com/make-a-will/ or by calling Kathleen at the Foyle Hospice on 71359888. The purpose of 'Make a Will Month' is to encourage people to write their Wills, whilst also raising much-needed funds for Foyle Hospice. Money raised will ensure Foyle Hospice can continue to deliver high quality specialist palliative care and end of life care to those in our community with life-limiting illness.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed - **https://youtube.com**@parishoferrigalderry.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £234,800.00.

Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.

St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar 07841407154.
St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media

outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**

Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**
If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.
Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.
We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.
Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:
(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) Errigal Development: Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c). (Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) (Errigal Parish: Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).
Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.
Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/ is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O'Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.
Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.
Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary's Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph's Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary's Church.